

NSC (National Statistical Commission)

- The NSC is mandated to evolve national policies and priorities relating to the statistical system, monitor and review the functioning of the statistical system in the light of laid down policies and recommend measures for enhanced performance and, above all, evolve measures for improving public trust in official statistics.
- set up through a **Gov resolution** on 1st June, 2005 on the recommendations of Rangarajan Commission
- constituted wef 12 July 2006 with a mandate to evolve policies, priorities and standards in statistical matters.
- comprises of: Chairman (part time- MoS level)+ 4 Members (part time)+ CEO- NITI AAYOG(ex-officio member) + CSI & Secretary, MoSPI (non-member, NSC Secretary)
- Past Chairpersons:

Tenure	Name
12-07-2006 to 15-02-2009 (First)	Prof. Suresh D. Tendulkar , Former Professor of Economics(DU)
30-07-2009 to 29-07-2012	Prof. R. Radhakrishna , Fellow, Centre for Economic and Social Studies, Hyderabad
25-02-2013 to 24-02-2016	Dr. Pronab Sen , Principal Adviser, Planning Commission
04.05.2016 to 31.07.2018	Dr. Radha Binod Barman , Former Executive Director, Reserve Bank of India
15 Jul 2019 - 14 Jul 2022	Prof. Bimal Kumar Roy, Former Director ISI

- Functions (13-point mandate):
 - (a) to identify the core statistics, which are of national importance and are critical to the development of the economy;
 - (b) to constitute professional committees or working groups to assist the Commission on various technical issues;
 - (c) to evolve national policies and priorities relating to the statistical system;
 - (d) to evolve standard statistical concepts, definitions, classifications and methodologies in different areas in statistics and lay down national quality standards on core statistics;
 - (e) to evolve national strategies for the collection, tabulation and dissemination of core statistics, including the release calendar for various data sets;
 - (f) to evolve national strategies for human resource development on official statistics including information technology and communication needs of the statistical system;
 - (g) to evolve measures for improving public trust in official statistics;
 - (h) to evolve measures for effective co-ordination with State Governments and Union Territory Administrations on statistical activities including strengthening of existing institutional mechanisms;
 - (i) to exercise statistical co-ordination between Ministries, Departments and other agencies of the Central Government;
 - (j) to exercise statistical audit over the statistical activities to ensure quality and integrity of the statistical products
 - (k) to recommend to the Central Government, or any State Government, as the case may be, measures to effectively implement the standards, strategies and other measures evolved under clauses (c) to (h)
 - (l) to advise the Government on the requirement of legislative measures on statistical matters including the statute for the National Statistical Commission.
 - (m) to monitor and review the functioning of the statistical system in the light of the laid down policies, standards and methodologies and recommend measures for enhanced performance.

- Commission has Powers to:
 - (a) require production of any document which in the opinion of the Commission will serve or may serve statistical purposes,
 - (b) require statistical agencies and institutions to provide details of statistical activities, including concepts and definitions used, methodologies followed, quality standards adopted, sampling and non-sampling errors, etc. in respect of 'core statistics', and
 - (c) require attendance of any person including any public servant on matters connected with core statistics
 - (d) issuing notices for the examination of witnesses and documents or any matters connected with core statistics
- Background of NSC: A Commission set up by the Government in January 2000 under the Chairmanship of Dr. C. Rangarajan (Former Governor, RBI) reviewed the statistical system and the entire gamut of Official Statistics in the country. The Rangarajan Commission submitted its report to the Government in August 2001. One of the key recommendations of this Commission was to establish a permanent National Commission on Statistics to serve as a nodal and empowered body for all core statistical activities of the country, evolve, monitor and enforce statistical priorities and standards and to ensure statistical co-ordination among the different agencies involved. The Rangarajan Commission also recommended that the Commission be set up initially through a Government order.
- Merger of NSSO and CSO:

"Along with the establishment of the National Statistical Commission, the Central Statistical Organisation (CSO) and the National Sample Survey Organisation (NSSO) will be merged into a single entity called the National Statistical Organisation (NSO), which will function as the executive wing of the Government of India in the field of statistics and act according to the policies and priorities as laid down by the NSC. The NSO would be headed by an Officer of the rank of Secretary to the Government of India, who will be designated as the Chief Statistician of India and he will also function as the

Secretary of the Commission. He will discharge the functions of Secretary of the Government of India in the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation."(As per Gazette notification (Gov resolution) dated 5 Nov,2019)

- Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released the draft **National Statistical Commission (NSC) Bill**, 2019 to make data collection more transparent and reliable. The present draft NSC Bill proposes to establish a National Statistical Commission as the **nodal and autonomous statutory body** for core statistical activities of the country. The Bill also proposes the NSC to be a body corporate. (10 Jan 2020)

[NSC Bill on RSTV](#)

Key Provisions of the Bill:

- **Composition:** The draft Bill proposes for a full time Chairman and members nominated from amongst eminent persons, including, Deputy Governor (**RBI**) as a member of the Commission and the Chief Economic Adviser as its ex-officio member.
- **Chief Statistician of India (CSI):** This position has been created to head the National Statistical Office (NSO). CSI will be a member of NSC.
- **Statistical Audit:** The bill provides for establishing a **National Statistical Audit and Assessment Organization** (within NSC) with a **Chief Statistical Auditor** in the rank of Secretary to the GOI.
- **Independent Secretariat:** To strengthen the autonomy of the Commission, the Bill proposes setting up of an independent secretariat to be headed by a Secretary rank officer of GOI.
 - It also envisages **financial autonomy** for the Commission through an independent **National Statistical Fund**.
- **Functions:** Its functions can be broadly classified as:
 - **Core Statistics: Nodal empowered body** for setting up mandatory standards in respect of Core Statistics defined as statistical indicators which are critical for monitoring the socio-economic policy of the government.

- **Standardization: Evolve, monitor and enforce** statistical priorities and parameters/standards for data by way of periodical review and audit.
- **Rationalization:** Ensure **strong coordination** through close linkage between budget and statistical programming agencies in order to create robust rationalized data.
- **Advisory:** The NSC can take up **suo-moto recognisance** of matters related to legislative and administrative policies and technology intervention issues of Center and States, and can advise the government on such matters.
 - It is empowered for timely **identification, collection, processing and dissemination** of reliable rationalized data.
 - It encourages other Government agencies to proactively bring forth issues pertaining to the national statistical system for discussion and deliberation.

Significance of the Bill:

- **Collection:** There was a need for the **structured collection of data** for many government programme interventions in order to help policy-makers to solve policy-related issues.
- **Providing more Teeth:** The revised composition of NSC aims to reinforce its independence and align it with the vision and broad contours of national policies and priorities.
- **Credible Data:** There is a dire need for the **availability of credible robust data** in the public domain so as to gain the trust of the people by preventing the spread of fake/ unreliable data. For instance, until now there was a data on homeless people in the country but it could not be shared with the agency providing housing.
 - This Bill provides statutory backing to the data collecting agency so as to increase the **credibility and legitimacy** of the data.

- Data needs a statistical approach in order to be **globally acceptable**. And the NSC will fill up this gap by working at arm's length from government and providing internationally accepted credible data.

3 Dec. 2022:

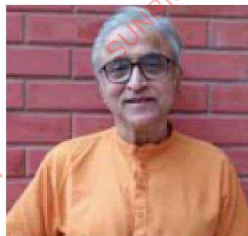
Laxman Karandikar⁺ appointed part-time chairperson of NSC

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Chennai Mathematical Institute (CMI) on Friday said that the Government of India had appointed Rajeeva Laxman Karandikar, Professor Emeritus at CMI, as the part-time chairperson of the National Statistical Commission of India for a period of three years.

Mr. Karandikar will take up this role as an additional responsibility while continuing as Professor Emeritus at CMI. He joined CMI as a visiting professor in 2010, and officiated as the Director of CMI from January 2011 to April 2021.

NSC is an autonomous body formed in June 2005



Rajeeva Laxman Karandikar

under the recommendation of the Dr. C Rangarajan Commission. The objective of its constitution was to reduce the problems faced by statistical agencies in the country with respect to the collection of data, and strengthen public trust in the numbers released by the Government of India.